changed the whole perception of security for the state. States are no longer invincible. They have become vulnerable preys to the latest technological discoveries of long-range cruise missiles, inter-continental ballistic missiles (ICBMs), short-range ballistic missiles (SRBMs), Multiple Independently Targetable Reentry Vehicles (MIRVs) and a host of other improved newer weapons of mass destruction. Added to this are the dangers of biological and chemical weapons. As John Herz (*International Policies in the Nuclear Age*, 1959) suggested that, given the nature of available weaponry, the traditional state system and security have become obsolete. States are no longer capable of protecting the lives of their citizens in the traditional sense. The Gulf War of 1991, and the US War on terror in Iraq and Afghanistan bear testimony of how helpless states have become in the face of brazen use of modern weapons of tremendous precision.

Further, today we find that there is a sharp decline in the ability of many governments to govern. This often results from the domestic challenges being faced by the states, which have international implications. Ethnic and religious forces are resulting in divided loyalty between these ethno-national and religious movements and states. These have resulted in disintegration of states in some cases, and in some such fissiparous forces have made the task of governance difficult. The ethnic strife in former Yugoslavia and Czechoslovakia led to the dismemberment of the states. Rwanda, Burundi and Somalia are experiencing clashes along ethnic lines that are horrific and often spill over into warfare. Therefore, observers contend that ethno-national multiculturalism is a potential long-term threat to the state's survival because the aspirations of ethno-national groups to a separate statehood becomes possible only through the fragmentation of the territorial integrity of the existing states. Partha Chatterjee (*The Nation and its Fragments*, 1993) points out that states are inherently fragile because all are weak coalitions of multiple nationalities that can splinter. The forces of religious fundamentalism, sometimes assuming international manifestation in the form of terrorist assaults, are now shaking the pillars of state authority.

However, to argue that the state, as the most primary unit in